during one interrogation session the purpose was to fool the Indian coast guard or other law enforcement officers in case they stopped the gunmen prior to the attacks.[10] However, the choice of Hyderabad is also notable given its location in the Deccan Plateau and the fact that Lashkar invented a fictitious group called the Deccan Mujahideen to take credit for the assault on Mumbai. In addition to their fake identities, the men were instructed to tie thread around their wrists, a common practice among Hindus.[11] An Indian national who was working as a Lashkar trainer also taught them Hindi.[12]

The would-be fidayeen then set off once more for Karachi for another day at sea, during which they were taught how to operate the inflatable dingy that would take them the final leg of their sea-borne journey. The men also learned how to open the sea valve on a boat so they could sink the ship that would take them most of the way there. It was September and the men were ready for their mission. They set out to sea with their handlers, but the boat purchased for their journey hit a rock. The attackers bound for a martyrdom operation in Mumbai almost drowned. Another boat brought them back to shore and Lashkar planned a second attempt. In October the squad set off once again with several handlers, this time in a rented vessel. They intended to capture an Indian ship to sail them into Indian waters, but as they approached their target its crew became aware of the impending danger, there was an exchange of gunfire and the Indian vessel evaded them.[13] Lashkar made its third attempt on 21 November. The ten-man fidayeen squad left Azizabad for a house by the seashore, and set out from there the following morning for the Arabian Sea, along with their handlers. Each of the ten men was equipped with a rucksack, an assault rifle, eight magazines with thirty rounds each, a 9mm pistol with three clips of ammunition, eight hand grenades, materials to make an improvised explosive device (IED), a knife, a water bottle, dried fruit and a mobile phone pre-programmed with their handlers' contact details. Every two-man team was given a GPS device. Kasab's partner, Ismail Khan, was chosen to lead the fidayeen squad and he received a satellite phone as well.[14]

The men boarded a small launch and set off to rendezvous with a ship named the *Al-Husseini*, which they boarded on 23 November along with other Lashkar members. Later that day, having entered Indian waters, the *Al-Husseini* took control of an Indian fishing vessel named the MV *Kuber*.